



## **Product Management and Human-Centered Design**

**United States Department of Agriculture (USDA)  
Procurement Operations Division  
Date: 04/08/2026**

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## **Section 1: Solicitation Information, Dates, and Deadlines**

### **1.1 High Overview**

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) is issuing this competitive request for quotes (RFQ) to GSA eBuy Schedule holders. This acquisition will result in a firm-fixed price (FFP) contract. The Agency will conduct this acquisition using FAR Part 8, specifically using FAR Part 8.405-3(b)(1)(ii)(B)(2) for solicitation (RFQ) purposes. The offeror is obligated to provide the services under the terms and conditions of the GSA schedule and this contract. This opportunity is set aside for women-owned small business (WOSB).

### **1.2 Amendment History**

The government reserves the right to revise or amend the specifics or the solicitation prior to closing time. Any amendments issued to this solicitation will be made available directly via email. It is the Offeror's responsibility to check for amendments. It is the sole discretion of the government to determine if the solicitation closing date will be extended due to an amendment. In such cases the amendment will include the new closing date and time.

### **1.3 Points of Contact / Contract Administration**

**Points of Contact:** The following points of contact are to be used to communicate with the government during the BPA and Call Order duration. During solicitation through award, the **Contracting Officer (CO) shall be the primary point of contact:**

**Contracting Officer (CO):**

Name: Corey Murzyn

Email: [corey.murzyn@usda.gov](mailto:corey.murzyn@usda.gov)

Phone: 970-295-5694

**Contracting Officer's Representative (COR):**

Designated in writing by the Contracting Officer at time of award.

### **1.4 Questions**

#### **1.4.1 Questions**

Questions shall be submitted via email. The deadline for submitting questions is 4:00pm ET, April 13, 2026. The government may combine questions for best possible response.

#### **1.4.2 Government Responses to Questions**

The government will publish responses to questions via an amendment to this solicitation and will be sent via email. The government reserves the right to transmit those questions and responses of a common interest to all prospective offerors. The government will evaluate questions and responses to determine if a second round of questions is required. If the government determines a second round of questions is required, the dates will be identified via an amendment.

## **1.5 Due Date and Delivery**

Quotes must be submitted on or prior to 4pm ET, April 16, 2026. USDA will not accept quotes received by fax or mail. BPA submissions are due at this listed date.

Offerors are to submit quotes electronically via email to the Contracting Officer.

**Subject line of the submittal email shall be formatted as follows: Product Management, Vendor Name.**

## **Section 2: Overview of Solicitation**

### **2.1 Background/Executive Summary**

The United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) provides leadership on food, agriculture, natural resources, rural development, nutrition, related issues based on sound public policy, and the best available science, and efficient management.

USDA expands economic opportunity through innovation, helping rural America to thrive; promotes agriculture production sustainability that better nourishes Americans while also helping feed others throughout the world; and preserves and conserves our Nation's natural resources through restored forests, improved watersheds, and healthy private working lands.

USDA is comprised of Departmental Management (DM) offices, Mission Areas (MA) and Agencies with employees located throughout the Continental United States (CONUS) and Outside CONUS (OCONUS). USDA Departmental Administration (DA) provides **centralized operational support, policy guidance, and administrative oversight** for all USDA agencies and offices. DA ensures that USDA's workforce, financial operations, IT infrastructure, and procurement processes run efficiently and in compliance with federal regulations.

### **2.2 Objective**

2.2.1 USDA's Office of the Chief Information Officer (OCIO) seeks senior product management and human-centered design expertise to help inform and drive priority application development and modernization efforts across the Department. These efforts are aligned to high priority Departmental initiatives, including but not limited to the [Farmer's First Policy Agenda](#), and the [National Farm Security Action Plan](#). A primary vision of USDA OCIO is to streamline service delivery to the public through well-defined, automated, and repeatable enterprise service offerings that can be leveraged across the Department to meet multiple program delivery needs.

## **2.3 Acquisition Details / General Contract Terms**

2.3.1 This solicitation is a Request for Quote being issued under NAICS 541515, Information Technology Professional Services.

2.3.2 This acquisition anticipates an award of a single-award Task Order against the GSA Federal Supply Schedule.

2.3.3 The Task Order will be Firm-Fixed Price.

2.3.4 This is a FAR Part 8.4 competitive acquisition. Per [FAR 8.401\(b\)](#) and [GSAM 538.7103-3\(a\)\(2\)](#). In which we have issued the RFQ to as many FSS contractors as practicable for this requirement.

2.3.5 This is not a source selection that is subject to FAR 15.3 procedures.

## **2.4 Period of Performance**

2.5.1 Period of Performance for this task order is anticipated as indicated in the table below:

|                 |                  |
|-----------------|------------------|
| Base Period     | Award + 7 months |
| Option Period 1 | 3 months         |
| Option Period 2 | 3 months         |
| Option Period 3 | 3 months         |

## **2.5 Approach**

For efficiency in this acquisition where experience and technical capability is crucial, the USDA will **not** make tradeoffs between price and non-price factors. The USDA will consider the quoter's Prior Experience to determine the quoters that represent the best value for establishment of a task order. Only the non-price factors are considered with the observations and best value analysis for award(s) captured to determine the best value for the government.

| Factor                     |
|----------------------------|
| Factor 1- Prior Experience |
| Price                      |

## **2.6 Business Size**

This RFQ has a women-owned small business set-aside on GSA FSS.

## **2.7 Incurring Costs**

This solicitation does not commit the government to pay any cost incurred in the submission of the quote or in making necessary studies of designs for the preparation thereof, nor to contract for services or supplies. The Contracting Officer is the only person who can legally obligate USDA for the expenditure of public funds in connection with this procurement.

## **2.8 Proprietary Data**

USDA recognizes that some information requested (e.g. pricing data), may be confidential. Proprietary information must be protected from improper disclosure under Federal law. The Offeror should appropriately mark submitted materials as proprietary, where such restrictions should apply.

## **2.9 News Releases**

The Offeror shall not make any news release pertaining to this procurement without prior USDA approval.

## **Section 3: Submission Instructions Provided to Offerors**

### **3.1 Guidelines and Formatting**

The following is established as the specific information and format required for any vendor submission. Incomplete quotes are not acceptable. Each offeror must submit one complete electronic submission to the CO via email.

Any submission in response to this solicitation must be in compliance with the terms and conditions outlined in the solicitation and attachments. All claimed capabilities to meet the requirements shall be realistic and are subject to verification by the government. Non-conformance with these instructions may result in rejection of the submission, unfavorable evaluation or being deemed ineligible for award.

To aid in the evaluation process, submissions shall be clear, concise, comprehensive, and shall include sufficient detail for effective evaluation and for substantiating the validity of stated claims. Submissions should not simply rephrase or restate the government's requirements but, rather, shall provide convincing rationale and examples to address how the vendor intends to meet these requirements. Vendors shall assume that the government has no prior knowledge of their experience and will base its evaluation on the information presented in the vendor submission.

Submissions shall be single-spaced, on 8.5 by 11 paper, have a minimum of one-inch margins and not less than 12-point font for text, 9-point font for tables and 8-point font for graphics. Tables and graphics may be landscape. All other text shall be portrait, double sided print. Offerors shall number each page. All vendor submissions shall be submitted in either MS Word, MS Excel or a searchable PDF as described in these instructions. Do not submit duplicates in all formats.

### **3.2 Volumes and Page Limits**

The Offeror's response to this solicitation shall comply with the following format and submission requirements. All vendor responses shall be submitted in the following volume format:

**Volume 1: Cover Letter/Capability Statement**

**Volume 2: Prior Experience**

**Volume 3: Price**

**Vendors shall not combine any volumes of their response. Vendors shall not include pricing information in any volume other than Volume 3.**

The following table outlines the specific page requirements for each volume and how information such as cover pages, table of contents, compliance matrixes, indexes, tabs etc. are to be included.

| Volume | Title                                    | Page Limits                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | <u>Cover Letter/Capability Statement</u> | None<br><b>To be indexed with a table of contents</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 2      | <u>Prior Experience</u>                  | 9 page limit<br>The Offeror shall provide up to three (3) examples of contracts performed within the last three (3) years and at least one year in length (recency) of similar scope, size, and complexity (relevancy) to the requirements of the Special Events and Conference Support Services experience detailed in the PWS |
| 3      | <u>Price</u>                             | No limit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

### **3.3 Cover Letter/Capability Statement (Volume 1)**

The offeror's cover letter and capability statement for the quote must contain the name, phone number and email address of the person to be contacted concerning any matter related to the solicitation. Include the following in this section:

- Point of Contact (Name, email, phone) for the representative the government should contact with questions regarding the quote.
- Company name and mailing address.
- SAM UEI number.
- Offerors must be registered and active in the SAM database. If registration is not active at *the time of receipt of quote* the offeror is not eligible for award. It is the sole responsibility of the offeror to complete SAM registration. Offerors may obtain information on registration at <https://sam.gov> and/or <https://www.acquisition.gov>.
- Current *GSA* Contract Number. Vendor must have the appropriate SIN and active GSA Multiple Award Schedule as listed in this RFQ. If this requirement is not met at quote submission the offeror is not eligible for award. It will be verified in accordance with section 4.2 of this RFQ.
- Date submitted and quote expiration date. All quotes must be valid for at least 90 days after the solicitation close date.

### **3.4 Non- Price Evaluation Factor 1: Prior Experience**

The Offeror shall provide up to three (3) examples of contracts performed within the last three (3) years and at least one year in length (recency) of similar scope, size, and complexity (relevancy) to the requirements of the Special Events and Conference Support Services experience detailed in the PWS.

The government reserves the right to obtain information from other sources (e.g., Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS)) to assess Offeror's performance risk.

The Government may consider positive and negative information not mentioned by the Offeror but found during the course of assessing relevant Prior Experience.

The proposal must illustrate clearly how the Offeror has successfully accomplished present and past projects, including accolades and failures. Reference efficiency, effectiveness, and flexibility with respect to timeliness, work quality, and types and scope of services provided. Failure to comply fully with the preceding may result in elimination of the proposal from further consideration.

The following will be used to evaluate prior experience:

1. **Recency:** Government and/or commercial contracts still in progress or completed within the past three (3) years that have at least one year of performance history.
2. **Relevancy:** One of the following Relevancy ratings from section 3 will be assigned.

Note: Offerors shall include the following details for each prior experience referenced in the written response above.

- a. Client organization name and client contact information
- b. Contract or Task Order Number
- c. Period of performance
- d. Objective of the prior project and team compositions/roles
- e. Product or project goals, outcomes, and impacts
  - Clearly demonstrable results showing how each Prior Experience example correlates to the service requirement as described in the Performance Work Statement with respect to complexity, magnitude, similarity, and scope. The burden of providing thorough and complete demonstrated past performance remains with the Offeror.

### **3.5 Price**

Offeror's price proposal shall be evaluated for fair and reasonableness. The Offeror shall submit Firm Fixed Price (FFP) for all support described herein using the attached Price Worksheet. Offerors shall provide fully loaded (or burdened) hourly rates for all labor categories required to perform tasks described in PWS.

All Firm Fixed Prices shall be for the government site. Use your normal business practice.

DO include information about offered labor categories, including education and experience (or Roles and Responsibilities), and hourly rates, in the Pricing Volume.

Pricing may be lower when providing competitive call order quotes but shall not exceed stated rates. Offeror will use labor category rates and hours required to perform work to develop firm fixed price quotes at the call order level.

DO NOT include technical documentation in the pricing volume. It will NOT be forwarded to the Technical Evaluation team.

## **Section 4: Evaluation Criteria Provided to Offerors**

### **4.1 Evaluation Approach**

For efficiency in this acquisition where experience and technical capability is crucial, the USDA will not make tradeoffs between price and non-price factors. The USDA will consider the offeror's Prior Experience to determine the offeror that represent the best value to the Government. Only the non-price factors are considered with the observations and best value analysis for award(s) captured to determine the best value for the government.

### **4.2 Compliance**

Quotes will be screened for compliance with all submission requirements as detailed in the solicitation. Quotes that do not meet the stated criteria could possibly be eliminated from further consideration.

### **4.3 Non-Price Evaluation Factor 1: Prior Experience**

In evaluating what was listed in section 3.4 of the RFQ- USDA will consider the offeror's Prior Experience and Capabilities to determine the offer that represents the best value for establishment of a task order.

### **4.4 Price**

In accordance with section 3.5 of this RFQ- Price will not be evaluated. Rather it will be reviewed to ensure offered pricing is the same or less than GSA pricing.

### **4.5 Evaluation Notices**

Award Notices- Unsuccessful and Successful Offerors will be notified in a timely manner of the award decision.

## **Section 5: Contract Award**

### **5.1 Award**

The government anticipates a single task order from this solicitation. USDA will not make tradeoffs between price and non-price factors. The USDA will consider the offeror's Prior Experience to determine the offer that represents the best value to the government.

For purposes of this solicitation, "best value" means the expected outcome of an acquisition that, in the government's estimation, provides the greatest overall benefit in response to the requirement. Offerors should therefore propose their best approach to meeting the requirements of the solicitation. Only the non-price factor is considered with the observations and best value analysis for award(s) captured to determine the best value for the government.

Once the government determines the offeror(s) that is best suited (i.e., the apparent successful contractor), the government reserves the right to directly communicate with that offeror to address any remaining issues, if necessary, and finalize the task order. Issues may include technical and price factors and/or disparities. If the parties cannot successfully address issues, as determined pertinent at

the sole discretion of the government, the government reserves the right to communicate with the next best-suited offeror based on the original analysis and address any remaining issues.’

## **Section 6: Solicitation Attachments**

### Attachments

Attachment 1: Performance Work Statement

Attachment 2: Price Worksheet

Attachment 3: USDA Clauses